TRIPP HORBINSKI

PLATFORM ENGINEER · MILWAUKEE, WISCONSIN

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Platform Engineer with 8 years of experience building cloud-native platforms, developer infrastructure, and distributed systems. Proven track record modernizing production systems, leading acquisition integrations, and delivering zero-downtime migrations at scale. AWS Certified Golden Jacket recipient with expertise in cloud architecture, Infrastructure as Code, CI/CD platforms, and developer tooling.

EXPERIENCE

GoFundMe, Senior Software Engineer — APR 2023 – OCT 2026 · REMOTE

- Served as a technical lead for the rebranding and domain consolidation of the acquired Classy platform under the GoFundMe Pro brand, coordinating changes across 27 services and delivering a zero-downtime migration from classy.org to pro.gofundme.com supporting millions of daily transactions without customer impact.
- Designed and implemented a dual-domain serving strategy using Cloudflare, CloudFront, Route53, ECS, and Lambda, enabling feature-flag-driven rollouts, gradual traffic migration, and safe rollback paths throughout the transition.
- Established deployment and infrastructure standards for customer-facing applications, introducing Infrastructure as Code and rollout patterns adopted across engineering teams to support future platform modernization efforts.
- Developed reusable GitHub Actions workflows and self-hosted runner infrastructure that enabled GoFundMe Pro repositories to migrate from Bitbucket to GitHub, eliminating AWS CodePipeline, standardizing CI/CD workflows, and simplifying software delivery across 8 engineering teams.
- Led migration of a mission-critical sharded MongoDB cluster powering GoFundMe Pro donation experiences from self-managed EC2 infrastructure to MongoDB Atlas, improving reliability, scalability, and operational efficiency.
- Modernized the company's Kong API platform by migrating from EC2 to ECS and implementing infrastructure-driven configuration management, improving reliability while reducing operational burden.
- Led re-architecture of GoFundMe Pro's annual donor receipts platform, designing a scalable AWS-based architecture capable of reliably processing high-volume annual communications while reducing operational complexity and improving maintainability.
- Mentored engineers through GoFundMe's mentorship program, providing guidance on cloud architecture, platform engineering, and software development practices.

Cardless, Lead Cloud Platform Engineer — AUG 2022 – JAN 2023 · REMOTE

- Codified 100% of production AWS infrastructure using Terraform, establishing a scalable Infrastructure-as-Code foundation that improved deployment reliability, operational consistency, and auditability.
- Authored and drove adoption of the company's first Infrastructure Roadmap, aligning leadership and engineering teams around strategic platform investments and long-term cloud architecture priorities.
- Led migration of production Kubernetes infrastructure to a new VPC, executing a phased strategy that maintained 99.9% uptime for critical services throughout the transition.
- Consolidated multiple DevOps tools into a unified CI/CD platform, reducing deployment times by 50% while simplifying software delivery workflows across engineering teams.

Veda, Cloud Engineer — JAN 2021 – AUG 2022 · REMOTE

- Designed and built cloud-native applications using Python and TypeScript, leveraging AWS CDK and Terraform to create reusable infrastructure and deployment patterns.
- Led the company-wide migration from GitHub to GitLab SaaS, architecting shared CI/CD pipelines and an autoscaling EC2 runner platform that improved build efficiency and developer experience.
- Implemented Datadog observability across AWS infrastructure and application workloads, providing actionable visibility into production performance and operational health.
- Mentored engineers on cloud architecture, infrastructure, and software engineering best practices through recurring office hours and internal technical publications.

Northwestern Mutual, Software Engineer — JUN 2018 – JAN 2021 · MILWAUKEE, WI

- Designed and maintained a shared GitLab CI/CD platform supporting 3,000+ engineers, standardizing security, testing, and deployment workflows while accelerating adoption through zero-touch change management and improved release velocity.

- Developed Python-based data collection systems and Amazon Redshift integrations that enabled engineering leadership to measure DORA metrics and improve software delivery performance.
- Served as an early contributor to enterprise adoption of AWS CDK, helping define reusable infrastructure constructs, documentation standards, and CI/CD integration patterns used across multiple engineering teams.

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Golden Jacket, Amazon Web Services — DEC 2023

Every AWS certification, the last of them earned December 30, 2023. The gold jacket is how AWS marks it.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, Terraform, AWS CDK, CloudFormation, Kubernetes, Docker, ECS, EKS, EC2, Lambda, CloudFront, Route53, IAM, VPC, RDS, DynamoDB, S3

Platform Engineering: GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD, Bitbucket, Infrastructure as Code, Platform Architecture, Developer Tooling, OpenTelemetry, Kong API Gateway

Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Bash, PHP

Data & Storage: PostgreSQL, MongoDB Atlas, MongoDB, Amazon Redshift

EDUCATION

Milwaukee School of Engineering, B.S. Software Engineering — 2014 – 2018 · MILWAUKEE, WI